



In memory of Lincoln's home

A log cabin commemorates the home on Knob Creek Farm, Kentucky, where Lincoln lived with his family from 1811 to 1816. The Lincolns' cabin was demolished; this one was the home of their friends, the Gollahers.

Attempt to conciliate

Lincoln's speech, delivered on March 4, 1861, was clear but conciliatory: "In your hands, my dissatisfied fellow countrymen, and not in mine, is the momentous issue of civil war. The government will not assail you ... You have no oath registered in Heaven to destroy the government, while I shall have the most solemn one to preserve, protect and defend it."

His words were to no avail. The next day, he read a dispatch from Major Robert Anderson warning of a crisis at Fort Sumter in Charleston. The threat of hostilities was escalating and would lead to war just over six weeks later.

Balancing act